

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-02-02

To the european bahá'í youth council

1 the european bahá'í youth council in Nove z amky, Slovakia

2 beloved friends,

The bahá'í communities of the european continent play a unique role

3 in the bahá'í world. in no other continent are there so many independent

4 national bahá'í communities in such a relatively small area speaking such

5 a diversity of languages, living in countries which, after centuries of inter-

6 necine strife, are being pulled by the force of providence into ever closer
collaboration. These countries are linked, moreover, by the ties of history

7 with every other part of the world.

8 The struggles of the european nations towards harmony and justice, the

9 periodic resurgence of violent opposition to the dual process of the eman-cipation
and unification of peoples, are a concentrated sample of the labor

10 of the whole world for the unification of humankind, which is the hallmark of this d
ispensation.

11 in this context one can better appreciate the importance of the devoted,

12 enthusiastic and collaborative activity of the bahá'í youth throughout eu-

13 rope. it is the very diversity and complexity of europe that required the es-290.1

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292 m eS Sa g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

293 656tablishment of the european bahá'í youth council as an institution which,

294 at one and the same time, facilitates collaboration among the european

295 bahá'í youth, assists them to have a united vision, and provides them with a

296 voice in the councils of other youth movements on that continent.

297 National youth committees have great responsibilities for the activities

298 of the young bahá'ís in their respective countries. may your efforts assist
299 them all to enrich the record of their already outstanding services to the
300 cause, to deepen their understanding of the Teachings of bahá'u'lláh, and
301 to uphold in every aspect of their lives the standards of behavior which he
302 has set before them.
303 it is our fervent prayer at the Sacred Threshold that your deliberations
304 at this gathering will give a new impetus to the endeavors of the european
305 bahá'í youth for the achievement of the four year plan as a basis for the
306 great work which lies ahead of them thereafter.
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**Release of a Document to Commemorate the End
of the Twentieth Century**

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]